

Iguanodontians

The iguanodontians were among the most common and widespread dinosaurs of the Late Jurassic and the Cretaceous. They varied from small, nondescript dinosaurs to giants with horselike faces and huge sails on their backs, but all had beaked mouths for eating plants. The iguanodontian group also includes the large duck-billed dinosaur family (next page).



FAMILY FACT FILE

Key features

- Toothless beaks for clipping plants
- Hooflike claws
- Mobile jaws able to chew plants
- Stiff tails

When

Iguanodontians appeared 156 million years ago, in the Late Jurassic Period. They died out at the end of the Cretaceous Period, 65 million years ago.



Iguanodon

ig-GWAH-no-don



- **When** 135–125 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Belgium, Germany, France, Spain, England
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 30 ft (9 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Discovered in the 1820s, *Iguanodon* was the second prehistoric animal to be identified as a dinosaur. Its name means “iguana teeth” as its teeth looked like those of an iguana but were 20 times bigger. *Iguanodon* was as

big as an elephant and walked mainly on all fours, feeding on low-growing plants. Its hind legs were larger and more powerful than its front legs, allowing it to stand and perhaps run on two feet.

► HANDY

The three middle fingers of Iguanodon's hands were joined to form a hoof. It could fold its little finger across its palm to grasp objects, and its thumb had a vicious spike, perhaps for self-defense.

Little finger

Thumb spike

